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70+ Vital Windows Commands Every Cybersecurity Analyst Should Master

Open the Command Prompt by pressing Win + R, typing "cmd", and pressing Enter.

No		Explanation	Sample Usage
1	<code>ipconfig</code>	Displays IP configuration information	<code>ipconfig /all</code> <code>ipconfig /?</code>
2	<code>systeminfo</code>	Displays system information	<code>systeminfo</code>
3	<code>netstat</code>	Displays network statistics	<code>netstat -ano</code>
4	<code>whoami</code>	Displays current user	<code>whoami</code>
5	<code>getmac</code>	Displays MAC address /v switch adds verbose output, providing more detailed information	<code>getmac /v</code>
6	<code>hostname</code>	Displays computer name	<code>hostname</code>
7	<code>ver</code>	Displays Windows version	<code>ver</code>
8	<code>winver</code>	Displays Windows version and build	<code>winver</code>
9	<code>ping</code>	Tests network connectivity Replace n [number] with the number of pings you want to send	<code>ping google.com</code> <code>ping -n google.com</code>
10	<code>tracert</code>	Traces route to a destination	<code>tracert microsoft.com</code>
11	<code>nslookup</code>	Queries DNS servers	<code>nslookup google.com</code>
12	<code>tasklist</code>	Lists running processes	<code>tasklist</code>
13	<code>taskkill</code>	Terminates processes /IM stands for "Image Name" The /F flag forces termination of the process	<code>taskkill /IM notepad.exe /F</code> <code>taskkill /PID process_id /F</code> <code>taskkill /IM chrome* /F</code> <code>taskkill /PID PID1 /PID PID2 /F</code>

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14	<code>sfc</code>	Scans and repairs system files	<code>sfc /scannow</code>
15	<code>chkdsk</code>	Checks disk for errors	<code>chkdsk C: /f</code>
16	<code>diskpart</code>	Manages disks and partitions	<code>diskpart</code> then <code>list disk</code>
17	<code>format</code>	Formats a disk	<code>format C: /fs:ntfs</code>
18	<code>xcopy</code>	Copies files and directories	<code>xcopy C:\source D:\dest /E</code>
19	<code>robocopy</code>	Advanced file copy utility	<code>robocopy C:\source D:\dest /E</code>
20	<code>dir</code>	Lists files and directories	<code>dir C:\</code>
21	<code>cd</code>	Changes directory	<code>cd C:\Users</code>
22	<code>md</code>	Creates a new directory	<code>md NewFolder</code>
23	<code>rd</code>	Removes a directory	<code>rd OldFolder</code>
24	<code>del</code>	Deletes files	<code>del C:\file.txt</code>
25	<code>copy</code>	Copies files	<code>copy C:\file.txt D:\</code>
26	<code>move</code>	Moves files	<code>move C:\file.txt D:\</code>
27	<code>ren</code>	Renames files or directories	<code>ren oldname.txt newname.txt</code>
28	<code>type</code>	Displays contents of a text file	<code>type C:\file.txt</code>
29	<code>find</code>	Searches for a text string in files	<code>find "error" C:\log.txt</code>
30	<code>findstr</code>	Searches for strings in files	<code>ipconfig /all findstr DNS</code>
31	<code>sort</code>	Sort the contents of a file named "names.txt" alphabetically.	<code>sort < names.txt</code>
32	<code>comp</code>	Compares contents of two files	<code>comp file1.txt file2.txt</code>
33	<code>fc</code>	Compares files and displays differences	<code>fc file1.txt file2.txt</code>

34	<code>tree</code>	Displays directory structure graphically	<code>tree C:\</code>
35	<code>attrib</code>	Changes file attributes	<code>attrib +r C:\file.txt</code>
36	<code>cipher</code>	Displays or alters file encryption	<code>cipher /e C:\SecretFolder</code>
37	<code>compact</code>	Displays or alters file compression	<code>compact /c C:\folder</code>
38	<code>powercfg</code>	Manages power settings	<code>powercfg /energy</code>
39	<code>shutdown</code>	Shuts down or restarts computer	<code>shutdown /r /t 0</code>
40	<code>gpupdate</code>	Updates Group Policy settings	<code>gpupdate /force</code>
41	<code>gpresult</code>	Displays Group Policy results	<code>gpresult /r</code>
42	<code>net user</code>	Manages user accounts	<code>net user JohnDoe newpassword</code>
43	<code>net localgroup</code>	Manages local groups	<code>net localgroup Administrators</code>
44	<code>net start</code>	Starts a network service	<code>net start "Print Spooler"</code>
45	<code>net stop</code>	Stops a network service	<code>net stop "Print Spooler"</code>
46	<code>netsh</code>	Network configuration tool	<code>netsh wlan show profiles</code>
47	<code>sc</code>	Manages Windows services	<code>sc query</code>
48	<code>reg</code>	Manages registry	<code>reg query HKLM\Software</code>
49	<code>runas</code>	Runs a program as a different user	<code>runas /user:Admin cmd</code>
50	<code>schtasks</code>	Schedules commands and programs	<code>schtasks /create /tn "MyTask" /tr notepad.exe /sc daily</code>

51	wmic	Windows Management Instrumentation Command-line, It is a powerful Windows utility that can be used for both legitimate system administration tasks and potentially abused by attackers.	<pre>wmic os get name,version,buidnumber</pre> This retrieves basic OS information. Software inventory: <pre>wmic product get name,version</pre> This lists installed software. Remote code execution: <pre>wmic /node:"victim_ip" process call create "powershell.exe -enc base64_encoded_payload"</pre> This executes a malicious PowerShell script on a remote system. Malware persistence: <pre>wmic startup create name="malware",command="C:\malw are.exe"</pre> This adds malware to the startup folder. Evasion technique: <pre>wmic process where name="antivirus.exe" delete</pre> Attackers may try to terminate security software.
52	assoc	Displays or modifies file extension associations	<pre>assoc .txt</pre>
53	ftype	Displays or modifies file types	<pre>ftype txtfile</pre>
54	driverquery	Displays installed device drivers	<pre>driverquery</pre>
55	msinfo32	Displays system information	<pre>msinfo32</pre>
56	mmc	Opens Microsoft Management Console	<pre>mmc</pre>
57	eventvwr	Opens Event Viewer	<pre>eventvwr</pre>
58	services.msc	Opens Services management console	<pre>services.msc</pre>

59	<code>devmgmt.msc</code>	Opens Device Manager	<code>devmgmt.msc</code>
60	<code>diskmgmt.msc</code>	Opens Disk Management	<code>diskmgmt.msc</code>
61	<code>taskmgr</code>	Opens Task Manager	<code>taskmgr</code>
62	<code>perfmon</code>	Opens Performance Monitor	<code>perfmon</code>
63	<code>resmon</code>	Opens Resource Monitor	<code>resmon</code>
64	<code>msconfig</code>	Opens System Configuration	<code>msconfig</code>
65	<code>control</code>	Opens Control Panel	<code>control</code>
66	<code>mstsc</code>	Opens Remote Desktop Connection	<code>mstsc</code>
67	<code>cleanmgr</code>	Opens Disk Cleanup	<code>cleanmgr</code>
68	<code>defrag C:</code>	Defragments a drive	<code>defrag C:</code>
69	<code>fsutil</code> <code>fsinfo</code> <code>drives</code>	File system utility	<code>fsutil fsinfo drives</code>
70	<code>path</code>	Displays or sets PATH environment variable	<code>path</code>
71	<code>set</code>	Displays, sets, or removes environment variables	<code>set</code>
72	<code>echo</code>	Displays messages or turns command echoing on/off	<code>echo Hello World</code>
73	<code>cls</code>	Clears the screen	<code>cls</code>
74	<code>query</code>	Displays information about processes that are running on a Remote Desktop Session Host (RD Session Host) server.	<code>query process *</code> To show all processes